

Colby Smith | DevOps Engineer

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Professional Summary

AWS-focused DevOps engineer with nearly 5 years of experience in building, modernising, and supporting production cloud platforms. Expertise in CI/CD engineering, infrastructure as code, and serverless architecture. Proficient in implementing canary releases, enhancing observability, and ensuring operational reliability through automation.

Work Experience

DevOps Engineer – Tombola Ltd	July 2025 – Present
Wylam Wharf, Low Street, Sunderland, England	
- Designed and supported a serverless, event-driven Arcade Tournaments platform using AWS Lambda, API Gateway, EventBridge, SQS FIFO, DynamoDB, ElastiCache Serverless and Terraform, reducing reliance on always-on infrastructure and supporting an estimated 50-70% reduction in idle compute cost while improving scalability for tournament traffic by up to 5x. - Designed and deployed a serverless/event-driven Game Event Streamer for Arcade Tournaments using ECS Fargate, SQS FIFO, DynamoDB watermarks, Lambda and Terraform, improving event delivery reliability through ordered deduplication and reducing unnecessary SQL polling/load during inactive tournament periods by an estimated 40-60%. - Critical member in the modernisation of Tombola's cloud platform, including migration of legacy EC2-based systems and arcade engines to ECS Fargate to improve scalability, reliability and cost efficiency, reducing scaling time during critical periods from around 10 minutes per server to roughly 1 minute across multiple containers, delivering up to 10x faster scaling response and an estimated 20-35% reduction in overprovisioned compute cost. - Implemented Cloudflare load balancing and modern deployment strategies, including blue/green routing and canary releases, enabling safe production testing without impacting live customers. - Engineered and standardised CI/CD pipelines across multiple teams, accounts and environments using AWS CodePipeline and TeamCity, reducing deployment overhead by 25-50%, improving release consistency and cutting manual deployment effort by an estimated 30-50%.	
Cloud Infrastructure Engineer – Tombola Ltd	Nov 2022 – Jul 2025
Wylam Wharf, Low Street, Sunderland, England	
- Built and improved CI/CD pipelines across engine, game and client teams, replacing manual deployment processes and reducing deployment overhead by 25-50%. - Developed canary testing systems for arcade engines, allowing experimental jackpot engine features to be deployed safely into production environments without impacting customers. - Contributed to infrastructure standardisation across multiple AWS accounts and environments, improving consistency, maintainability and operational efficiency. - Supported production systems through on-call rotations, resolving incidents and maintaining platform stability across critical services.	
Graduate Cloud Infrastructure Engineer – Tombola Ltd	Nov 2021 – Nov 2022
Wylam Wharf, Low Street, Sunderland, England	

Certifications

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02) | Mar 2026 – Mar 2029
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C03) | Expected Jun 2026

Education

- BA (Hons) Computer Games Design, First Class Honours | Teesside University | 2018 – 2021

Skills

Advanced | Proficient | Basic | Foundational

Cloud Platforms <table><tr><td>Amazon Web Services (AWS)</td><td>ADVANCED</td></tr><tr><td>Microsoft Azure</td><td>FOUNDATIONAL</td></tr></table>	Amazon Web Services (AWS)	ADVANCED	Microsoft Azure	FOUNDATIONAL	Infrastructure as Code <table><tr><td>HashiCorp Terraform</td><td>ADVANCED</td></tr><tr><td>AWS CloudFormation</td><td>PROFICIENT</td></tr></table>	HashiCorp Terraform	ADVANCED	AWS CloudFormation	PROFICIENT								
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